EYE TO THE FUTURE

PEYUSH BANSAL, 37
AMIT CHAUDHARY, 34
RAMNEEK KHURANA, 35

Co-founders, Lenskart
New Delhi

"To build futuristic firms, it's important to not get swayed by market or investor benchmarks, but set one's own"

PEYUSH BANSAL

The limited success of his ventures, searchmycampus.com and Valyoo Technologies, prompted Peyush Bansal to return to India from the US in 2010 and start an eyewear start-up. Lenskart, set up with the help of friends Amit Chaudhary, Sumeet Kapahi and Ramneek Khurana, adopted the hybrid model—online and brick and mortar stores. Bansal was confident the Indian market would provide him scale. Starting with contact lenses, Lenskart today has 600-odd retail stores and claims to cater to over 100,000 customers a month with over 4,000 types of eyewear and other eyecare products. Lenskart's valuation touched $1.5 billion (Rs 11,355 crore) in 2019 after a $275 million (Rs 2,080 crore) investment from Softbank. Bansal, Chaudhary and Kapahi have worked hard to streamline operations. Their facility in Delhi can produce 300,000 glasses a month; 20 per cent of the frames are produced in China's Zhengzhou. Kapahi handles supplies while Chaudhury is an expert in organisational development. Bansal, of course, is the brain behind Lenskart. ■

–Anilesh S. Mahajan

TRAINING GROUND Bansal picked up the nuts and bolts of the eyewear business through his Valyoo Technologies venture in the US



FRAME BY FRAME
Bansal (right) with Chaudhary

VIVAN MEHRA